

MONEY

Matters

Let the penguin pinch your pennies

In Linux, two accounting packages called GnuCash and Quasar do all your money management for you. GnuCash, with its simple to use interface is more suited to home users or amateurs, while Quasar is a more professional financial accounting software, suitable for professional users such as chartered accountants and so called advanced users.

GnuCash

GnuCash allows you to track bank accounts, stocks, income and expenses. It is an easy-to-use software based on professional accounting principles to ensure balanced books and accurate reports. This software comes bundled with most distributions such as Red Hat and ELX.

As soon as you start the software, it prompts you to choose from either 'Create a new set of accounts', 'Import files', or 'Start tutorial'. Start with the 'Create a new set of accounts' option.

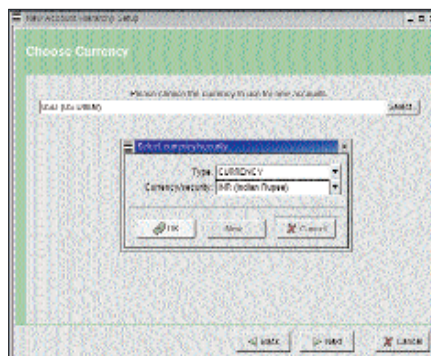
Now a new account setup druid starts. This druid helps you create the basic

accounts that are needed to start your finance management and accounting actions. The next step the druid does is to select the currency. Click 'Select button', keep the Type as Currency, set 'Currency/security' to 'INR' and press OK.

To create accounts, select the categories that are applicable to you. All the necessary account heads relating to that category will be created automatically. For

example, if you select 'Common Accounts', the category will include all accounts that would be needed by you to maintain your accounts. Accounts thus created will consist of income accounts such as salary, expense accounts such as education, insurance, taxes, etc. It will also include assets and liabilities accounts such as credit cards and savings accounts. Press Next to create all the selected accounts. Once the accounts are created you need to specify the opening balance for the accounts. Finally, press Finish to get out of this druid. Now you can enter the figures on a day-to-day basis. But before you start, make sure you have changed the default date format. Navigate to **Settings > Preferences > International**, and set the date format to UK (mm-dd-yyyy).

Now you can begin managing your moolah. First, enter the salary details. To do this, expand the Income group by clicking the 'plus' sign next to Income, and then double-click on the Salary entry. A new window will appear as a column.



Set the default currency in GnuCash to have all values displayed in a currency of your choice